Hrishikesh Nanda

Product Designer

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Product Designer who owns complex products end to end. At Upstox (India's Robinhood equivalent, 10M+ registered users), redesigned account opening across Android, iOS and web, and designed internal and developer tools, working from backend system behavior and regulatory constraints through to high-precision visual interfaces. Combines design craftsmanship from **IIT Guwahati** with AI-driven product engineering and hands-on mechanical and hardware systems tinkering.

EXPERIENCE

Upstox · Product Designer

2022 — 2023 · Bangalore

India's leading retail brokerage platform (Robinhood equivalent for the Indian market) with 10M+ registered users and ~3M active traders.

NAO 2.0, Native Account Opening — project owner

Aug 2022 — Feb 2023

- **Redesigned Upstox's account opening, end to end** — signup through to e-sign, on Android, iOS and web. Audited drop-off/rejection data across the funnel (losing ~60% of leads, 35% post-submission rejections, 40% requiring sales calls); replacing manual entry across email, PAN, bank and photo steps raised overall conversion by +7.8%.
- **Modular System Architecture:** Rebuilt six core blocks (Email SSO, PAN, Bank Verification, Liveness Photo, Signature, E-sign). Specced a backend 'Templates & Blocks' CMS architecture, enabling PMs to configure flows and match thresholds remotely without code releases.
- **Automated Verification Integrations:** Integrated single-tap Apple Sign-In (iOS) and Google SSO (email step 85.0% → 89.9%), an Equifax background check for PAN, real-time HyperVerge Liveness SDK (photo rejection dropped from 18.5% to 1.0%), and Setu UPI Reverse Penny Drop for instant bank verification.
- **Friction Reduction & Signature Canvas:** Designed landscape digital signature canvas with animated priming guide and zero-state reset policy (slashing 21.3% signature rejection rate). Cut mandatory manual inputs from 15 to 9 and document uploads from 3 to 0.

Up.alert Notification Dashboard — sole designer

Nov — Dec 2022

- **Internal Communication Platform:** Designed the internal web dashboard enabling marketing and content teams to broadcast push notifications and in-app alert banners to 10M+ users without engineering dependency.
- **Safety & Crisis Guardrails:** Built essential fail-safes into the UI: permanent test-vs-production environment indicators, mandatory Test_ audience prefixing, real-time audience verification counts before send, and pause/resume controls for live warning banners.
- **Analytics & Targeting:** Designed CSV audience targeting supporting dynamic $variable placeholders and an integrated Mixpanel analytics view (sends, deliveries, clicks) that doubles as an audit trail.

Invest Logos — design lead

2022

- **Visual Craftsmanship at Scale:** Led the initiative to introduce stock logos in Upstox Lite ; a first among Indian brokerages where exchanges publish plain text. Established visual style guidelines, small-scale legibility standards, fallback rules, and SVG vector requirements.
- **Team Leadership & Quality Control:** Directed a team of 5–10 junior designers and interns, producing, verifying, and deploying ~2,180 production vector assets into the live application.

Account Centre and Developer API Console

July — September 2022

- **Responsive Shell Architecture:** Architected the unified desktop/mobile web shell for Account Centre prior to screen rollout; establishing grid systems (SM/LG breakpoints), top-bar navigation rules, scroll pinning, and comprehensive edge-case states (empty, 404, loading skeletons, error recovery).
- **Developer API Console:** Owned full UI design for third-party developer API management. Designed app creation, plan subscriptions, wallet billing around async API behavior, a dedicated self-serve sandbox environment, error state UX, and SEBI multi-factor login compliance (OTP + PIN).

Ani! · Co-founder and Founding Designer

2023 — 2024

- **0-to-1 Mobile Creation:** Designed the anime social platform Ani! (iOS & Android) originating from a MyAnimeList UI redesign concept. Partnered with technical co-founder to ship watchlist tracking, fan art UGC publishing, real-time chatrooms, and social feeds.

Trophee · Founding Product Designer (Freelance)

2021 — 2022 · Singapore

- **Manga Reader & WebApp:** Sole designer for Singapore Web3 manga platform. Designed visual identity, mascot, design system, and a multi-directional reader supporting 4 reading directions across Manga, Manhwa, and Manhua.
- **Responsive System Architecture:** Shipped web alpha in April 2022 by engineering responsive tokenized components that mapped from mobile layouts to desktop viewports with zero design rework.

APPLIED AI RESEARCH & INDEPENDENT SYSTEMS · 2026

- **AI-Driven Android Accessibility Agent:** Architected an autonomous Android accessibility system enabling blind, low-vision, and motor-impaired users to execute multi-step native app tasks without sight. Engineered interaction model on accessibility tree parsing, multi-tier reversible safety gates (Silent, Announce, Halt), and a non-visual press-and-hold haptic confirmation loop preventing irreversible mis-triggers. Designed around Android Advanced Protection Mode and FLAG_SECURE banking constraints.
- **Autonomous Infrastructure Control Plane:** Designed an agentic control plane and safety trust layer for enterprise Linux server fleets. Replaced unconstrained autonomy with deterministic human-in-the-loop oversight: natural language intent-to-policy translation, multi-stage approval gates ('The agent proposes, policy consents'), signed transaction ledgers, and automated kernel rollback guardrails.

SYSTEMS, HARDWARE & AUTOMOTIVE ENGINEERING

NikOttO Pvt. Ltd. · ECU Calibration & Engineering — 2025

- **ECU Calibration & Telemetry:** Engine Control Unit (ECU) electronic calibration, air-fuel mixture and sensor tuning at an IIT Madras-incubated automotive startup; gaining hands-on expertise in low-level electronic hardware, diagnostics, and sensor telemetry.
- **Mechanical Diagnostics & Restoration:** Applied rigorous systems troubleshooting and physical tolerances to vehicle rebuilds under a "fix over replace" ethos — rebuilt engine mounts, head gasket, intake/exhaust systems on a Suzuki SY416; resurrected a seized auction Honda CBR250R over 3 months; pursuing turbo tuning on a 2011 Skoda Laura.
- **Low-Level Systems & Firmware:** Compiling custom Android OS kernels, custom recoveries and OS builds (from 2012~2013); runs Arch Linux across daily driver hardware; repairs and restores legacy laptop/PC architecture.

EDUCATION

IIT G (Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati) B.Des · 2018 — 2022

SKILLS

Design Figma · Design Systems & Componentry · State & Edge-Case Design · Native iOS/Android UI Patterns · Data Visualisation · System Architecture (Templates & Blocks)

Build HTML, CSS, JavaScript · SQL · Git · Arch Linux · LLM & Agent Tooling · Hardware-Software Interactions

VOLUNTEERING

Broseph Foundation · 2024 — 2026

Social work and charitable organisation. Supported efforts to report and address privacy violations against women online. Volunteered at orphanages — donated food and clothing, and spent time directly with the children. City clean-up initiatives.